

Indian Forest Service Benevolent and Welfare Trust

Comparison of the three best State compensation orders for forest personnel

Maharashtra, Telangana, and Karnataka | Position as on September 27, 2026

Of the ten State instruments, these three are the strongest. Each is a dedicated order for forest staff who die or are injured on duty, and each is funded by the State. Tamil Nadu and Rajasthan provide larger sums, but through salary-account bank tie-ups rather than State orders, so they are treated separately.

Feature	Maharashtra	Telangana	Karnataka
Instrument	GR No. FST-11/21/Pr. Kra. 248/F-4, Revenue and Forest Department	G.O.Ms.No.43, Environment, Forest, Science and Technology (FOR-II) Department	GO No. FEE 08 FNG 2019; GO No. FEE 95 FAP 2021 (Part-1); GO No. FEE 95 FAP 2021, Forest, Ecology and Environment Department
Date	October 12, 2022	April 3, 2023	June 5, 2020; December 1, 2022; October 3, 2023
Validity	Standing order	Standing order	Standing orders
Death	Rs. 25 lakh, the same for Groups A to D	Beat Officer Rs. 30 lakh; Section Officer / Deputy RO Rs. 45 lakh; RO Rs. 50 lakh; ACF / DCF Rs. 75 lakh; IFS Rs. 1 crore	Rs. 60 lakh in aggregate (Rs. 50 lakh ex-gratia plus Rs. 10 lakh Special Ex-Gratia Amount); Rs. 5 lakh for welfare-scheme and temporary staff
Permanent disability	Rs. 3 lakh to Rs. 3.60 lakh, by Group	Rs. 20 lakh to Rs. 50 lakh, by cadre	Rs. 10 lakh
Grievous hurt	Not separately provided	Rs. 3 lakh to Rs. 6 lakh, by cadre	Rs. 2 lakh
Family livelihood	Compassionate appointment, or notional pay with promotions and increments till superannuation	None	None
Other benefits	Transport of mortal remains with one escort; full in-State medical costs	None	None
Payment safeguard	Fixed deposit in heirs' joint names, locked for 10 years; monthly interest payable	Lump sum	Released by the department in place of insurance premium
Triggers	Forest fire, wild-animal attack, smugglers or poachers, wildlife rescue	Attack by extremist or anti-social elements only	Death or injury on duty; human threats not named
Staff covered	Groups A to D	Forest Beat Officer to IFS	Range Forest Officer, Deputy RFO, Forest Guard, Vehicle Driver, Forest Watcher, elephant staff; ACF and above, IFS, and SFS excluded
Main gap	Very low disability amount	Narrow trigger; lower ranks, who face the most risk, get the least	Frontline only; disability and injury amounts not raised since 2020

Why each ranks where it does

1. Maharashtra: best in design

Its amount is modest, **but it is the only order that looks after the family over the long term.**

- **Uniform lump sum.** A Forest Guard's family receives the same Rs. 25 lakh as an officer's.
- **Continued income.** The family keeps an income through compassionate appointment or notional pay till superannuation.
- **Practical costs covered.** Transport of the body and medical treatment are paid for.
- **Protected payout.** The fixed-deposit lock keeps the money from being spent quickly.

- **Realistic triggers.** Forest fire, wild animals, smugglers, and poachers account for nearly all frontline deaths.

Raising the disability amount, now Rs. 3 lakh to Rs. 3.60 lakh against Rs. 25 lakh on death, is the one change it needs.

2. **Telangana: best in amount and injury cover**

It pays the highest State-funded amounts on file for death, disability, and grievous hurt, and its disability amounts are proportionate to the death benefit. It treats forest staff on par with the police and names extremist and anti-social elements as the threat, which supports the case that forest protection is dangerous work. It has two weaknesses:

- **Narrow trigger.** A Range Officer killed by an elephant or in a forest fire receives nothing under it.
- **Grading against risk.** The **Beat Officer, who patrols alone and faces the most danger, receives the smallest amount.**

3. **Karnataka: best death benefit for the frontline**

Rs. 60 lakh is the highest State-funded sum for the staff most at risk, and it reaches Forest Watchers. The successive revisions from 2018 to 2023 show a State willing to keep raising it. Its limits:

- **Death benefit only raised.** Disablement (Rs. 10 lakh) and grievous injury (Rs. 2 lakh) stay at 2020 levels; a proposal to raise them to Rs. 20 lakh and Rs. 10 lakh was not accepted.
- **Officers excluded.** Extension to ACF and above, IFS, and SFS officers was sought and not granted.
- **Threat not named.** It does not name smugglers or poachers, so it is less useful as an outreach precedent than Maharashtra or Telangana.

Model for other States

The **model for other States is Maharashtra's structure**, with the death amount raised towards Karnataka's level, and Telangana's disability and grievous-hurt amounts added. For enclosures to Chief Ministers, Maharashtra and Telangana remain the preferred pair because each expressly names the human threat.

Amounts are as stated in the operative instruments on file.